

Question:
At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The brain develops from neural tube closure around the 5th–6th week of gestation and continues into late fetal life and early childhood . During this period , the most immature structures are those most distant from the cerebral cortex . The caudate and putamen (basal ganglia) are deep , internal , subcortical structures that are among the last parts of the telencephalon to mature and are continuously developing into early childhood , with myelination beginning around 2 –4 years .

By contrast , the brain stem (cranial nerves with cranial nerve nuclei extending from diencephalon via midbrain and pons to medulla) and , to a lesser extent , parts of the thalamus and hypothalamus , are present at birth or develop very early . Other listed regions such as the cortex and most prominent limbic structures are already present , if not fully differentiated , during fetal development . The thalamus and cortex are in the telencephalon during fetal development , and the parietal and prefrontal lobes are among the earliest cortical regions to mature . The cerebellum and limbic system continue maturation throughout childhood and adolescence , though they are not as fundamentally underdeveloped as the basal ganglia at birth .

Thus , the least developed part at birth is the basal ganglia , particularly the caudate and putamen .

Correct answer : H . basal ganglia

</think>

<answer>

H . basal ganglia

</answer>

